

Exercise 7

Experimenting with App Layouts and Color Schemes: A Design, Feedback, and Refinement Approach

Register Number:230701199

Tool Used: GIMP

AIM

The aim is to trial different app layouts and color schemes and evaluate user feedback on aesthetics and usability using GIMP.

INTRODUCTION

In this exercise, I explored the process of designing an app layout by experimenting with different color schemes and structures.

The main objective was not just to create visually appealing screens but also to focus on aesthetics, usability, and user experience.

After designing multiple versions, I collected (imaginary) user feedback to understand preferences and pain points.

Based on the feedback, I refined the design, selected the most effective color and layout combination, and finalized professional, user-friendly app screens.

This documentation explains each step I followed — from the initial design to feedback evaluation and final improvements — as per the given exercise guidelines.

LAYOUT DESIGN PROCESS

I started by creating a new design project.

I made a simple app layout with three main screens:

- Home Page
- Signup Page
- Login Page

I added basic UI elements like:

- Text elements (Titles, Subtitles)
- Input fields for user details

- Buttons for navigation and submission

I arranged all parts in a neatly organized structure, using proper alignment and spacing for clarity.

EXPERIMENTATION WITH COLOR SCHEMES

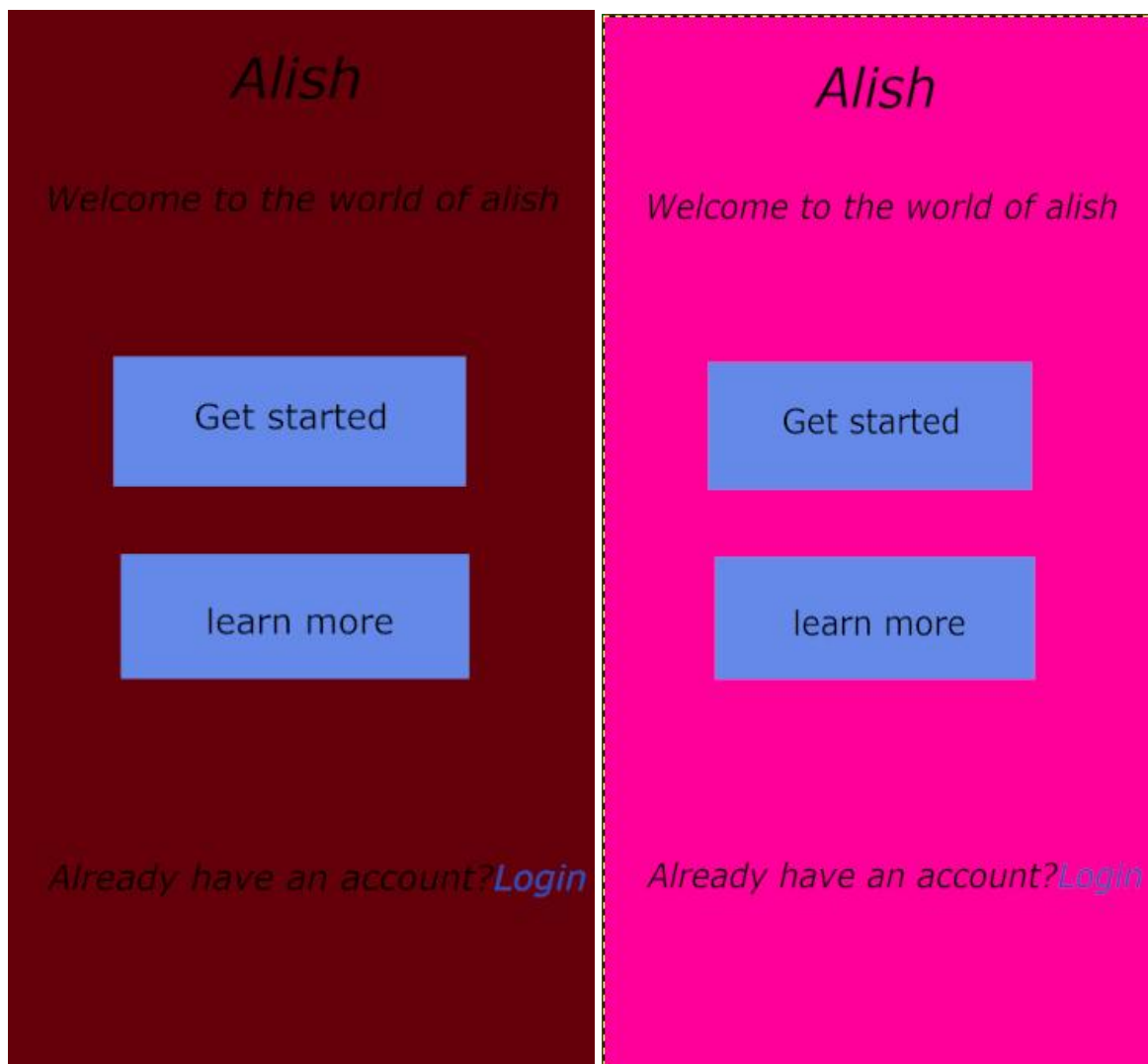
Home Page (Initial Versions)

Version 1:

- Background: Dark Maroon
- Buttons: Blue

Version 2:

- Background: Bright Pink
- Buttons: Blue



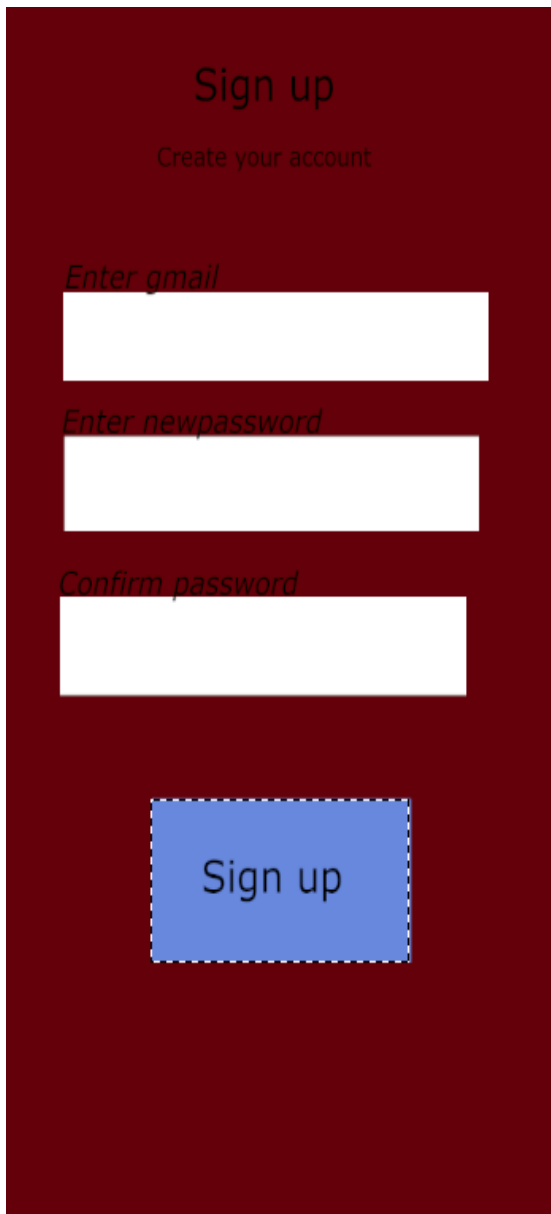
Signup Page (Initial Versions)

Version 1:

- Background: Dark Maroon
- White Input Fields
- Blue Button

Version 2:

- Background: Bright pink
- White Input Fields
- Blue Button



Sign up

Create your account

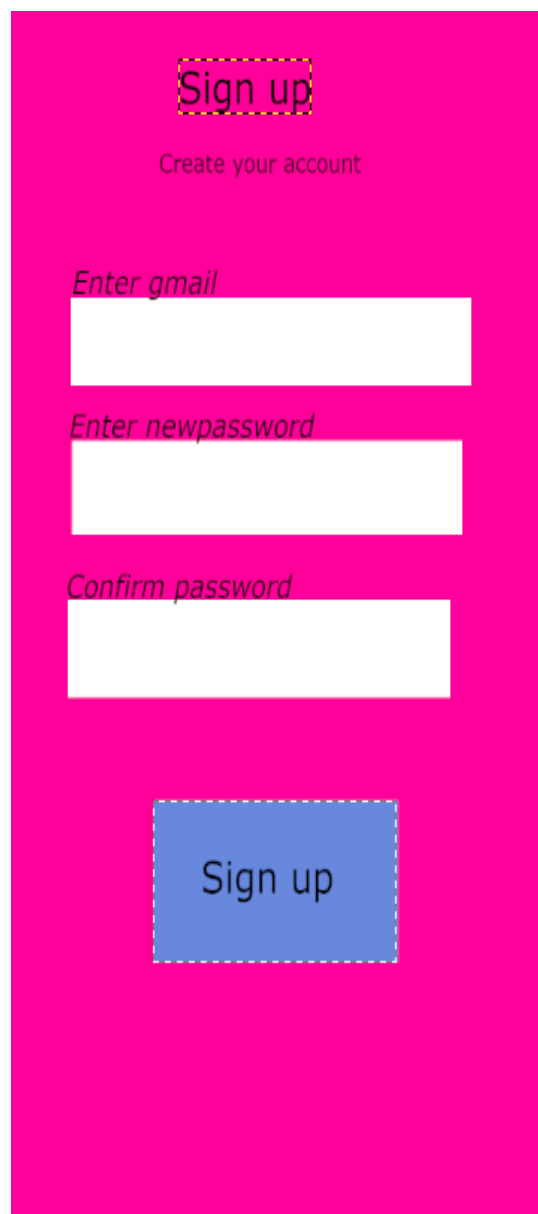
Enter gmail

Enter newpassword

Confirm password

Sign up

This mockup shows a dark maroon background. At the top, the text 'Sign up' is centered in a large, bold, black font, with 'Create your account' centered below it in a smaller black font. There are three white input fields stacked vertically. The first is preceded by the italicized text 'Enter gmail', the second by 'Enter newpassword', and the third by 'Confirm password'. At the bottom, there is a blue rectangular button with the text 'Sign up' in black. All text and the button have a dashed white border.



Sign up

Create your account

Enter gmail

Enter newpassword

Confirm password

Sign up

This mockup shows a bright pink background. The layout is identical to Version 1, with 'Sign up' and 'Create your account' at the top, three white input fields in the middle, and a blue 'Sign up' button at the bottom. The text and button are styled the same as in Version 1, but the overall background color is bright pink.

Login Page (Initial Versions)

Version 1:

- Background: Dark Maroon
- White Input Fields
- Blue Button

Version 2:

- Background: Bright Pink
- White Input Fields
- Blue Button

The image displays two side-by-side login page mockups. Version 1 (left) has a dark maroon background. It features a 'Welcome back!' message in a cursive font, enclosed in a dashed yellow box. Below this is a label 'Enter username/email adress' and a white input field. Further down is a 'Password' label and another white input field. At the bottom is a blue 'Login' button with a dashed white border. Version 2 (right) has a bright pink background. It features the same 'Welcome back!' message in a cursive font. Below this is a label 'Enter username/email adress' and a white input field. Further down is a 'Password' label and another white input field. At the bottom is a blue 'Login' button with a dashed white border.

Welcome back!

Enter username/email adress

Password

Login

Welcome back!

Enter username/email adress

Password

Login

USER FEEDBACK COLLECTION

I conducted an imaginary feedback collection session to get perceptions about the designs. Here are the feedback points received:

- **Home Page (Maroon Background):**
 - Looked too dark and serious.
 - Buttons were good but not very lively.
- **Home Page (Pink Background):**
 - Very vibrant but a little harsh on the eyes for daily use.
- **Signup Page (Pink Background):**
 - Very bright and overwhelming.
 - Input fields were clear, but background distracted users.
- **Signup Page (Maroon Background):**
 - Slightly better than pink.
 - Still, background color needed to be softer for professional use.
- **Login Page (Maroon Background):**
 - Looked too dark and heavy.
 - Buttons were visible but the screen felt dull and serious.
- **Login Page (Pink Background):**
 - Bright but too distracting.
 - Input fields were clear but background took away user focus.

REACTION TO FEEDBACK AND REFINEMENT

After evaluating feedback, I made the following refinements:

- **For Home Page:**
 - Changed background to Light Blue (#B0E0E6) for a soft, welcoming look.
 - Maintained the Blue Buttons.
- **For Signup Page:**
 - Changed background to Light Blue (#B0E0E6) (same as Home Page) for consistency.

- Input fields kept white for clarity.
- Button colored Blue (#6A8CCD) for a calm, professional feel.
- Aligned text elements neatly.
- **For Login Page:**
 - Updated background to Light Blue (#B0E0E6) for a softer, welcoming login experience.
 - Retained White input fields for clarity.
 - Used the same Blue (#6A8CCD) for the Login button for consistency.
 - Made welcome text ("Welcome back!") bold and more friendly.

All UI elements were aligned properly with better padding, ensuring that the design not only looked good but also supported excellent usability.

Alish

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Already have an account? [Login](#)

Sign up

Create your account

Enter gmail

Enter newpassword

Confirm password

Sign up

Welcome back!

Enter username/email adress

Password

Login

FINAL COLOR CODES USED

UI Element	Color	Hex Code
Home Page Background	Light Blue	#B0E0E6
Signup Page Background	Light Blue	#B0E0E6
Login Page Background	Light Blue	#B0E0E6
Button	Blue	#6A8CCD

UI Element	Color	Hex Code
Input Fields	White	#FFFFFF
Text	Black	#000000

FINAL RESULT

After completing the above steps:

- I achieved a professional, user-friendly, and visually pleasing app layout for the Home, Signup, and Login Pages.
- I made design decisions based on user feedback, improving the overall user experience.
- The final versions satisfy both aesthetic beauty and usability as per the objective of the assignment.

CONCLUSION

Through this exercise, I learned the importance of:

- Exploring different layouts and color schemes,
- Collecting and reacting to feedback, and
- Refining the design to suit both aesthetic and functional needs.

The final app layouts achieved a balance of professional appearance, ease of use, and user comfort, perfectly meeting the aims of the exercise.